

B2 First for Schools Speaking Part 3

Aims of the lesson	- to familiarise students with the Part 3 task and give them strategies to deal with it - to practice a Part 3 activity
Time needed	50–60 minutes
Materials required	- Student's worksheet (one copy for each student) - Sample task (one copy for each pair of students)

Procedure

- Write the following list of activities on the board:
 - swimming
 - walking
 - cycling
 - dancing
 - running
- Ask the students the following question:
 - Why might it be a good idea for teenagers to do these activities?*
 - Can you think of any problems or disadvantages?*
- Elicit feedback from the class, encouraging as many students as possible to make a comment.
- Arrange students into pairs, and ask them to decide which two activities from the list are the best for keeping fit. Allow up to 3 minutes for this. Monitor students' conversations, listening for examples of key skills required in this task:
 - turn-taking
 - negotiating
 - making suggestions
 - exchanging ideas and opinions
 - justifying opinions
 - ranking
 - evaluating
 - selecting

Make a note of their strengths and weaknesses, using these to plan future classes so students can express the functions they need to do this effectively.

- Elicit some feedback from the whole class – there is no need for them to reach a consensus. Feed back some examples of good performances and good functional exponents used. Reassure students you will come back to these in future classes.
- Tell the students that in Part 3 of the Speaking test, they have to do a similar activity. Give out a copy of the **Sample task** to each pair of students and ask the students to have a look at it, but not to do it yet.
- Give out the **Student's worksheet**. Ask students to do the matching task in pairs. Feed back with the whole class and deal with any queries (see **Answer key**).

8. Board the following useful phrases:

- I see what you mean, if we ..., we can...
- I'm not sure, don't you think it would be better if (we)...
- It depends, on the one hand... while...
- It depends, if..., but if...

Ask them which phrases means 'I agree', 'I disagree', 'Maybe' Point out that it is good to have good alternatives to phrases like 'I agree' which can sound a little unnatural. Also point out that all these phrases lead the speaker to develop what their partner has said and should be practiced.

Next board:

- When it comes to...
- As far as ... is concerned...
- Moving onto...

Point out that these are very useful for managing the conversation and encourage them to try to use them.

9. Now go back to the **Sample task** given in **6** above. Read out the first question, and give students 2 minutes to discuss the options. After 2 minutes ask the second question, which prompts students to reach a decision: 'Which two would be the easiest to do well.'
10. Monitor the students as they talk, making a note of examples of good performance as well as areas for improvement.
11. Ask the students how they think they could improve their performance in this part of the Speaking test. Point out that they will be doing lots of discussion activities to help them develop the skills and confidence they need for this part of the test.

Additional information

- Classroom activities which focus on turn-taking can help students to prepare for Part 3, as well as learning the appropriate language. Students need to be taught and have practice in the following skills: turn-taking; negotiation; making suggestions; exchanging ideas and opinions; justifying opinions; ranking; evaluating; selecting.
- Students need strategies and appropriate language for disagreeing in a friendly way. Strong disagreement may undermine a candidate's confidence; an overbearing candidate may also lose marks for not taking turns appropriately.
- No marks are deducted for asking for instructions to be repeated, and it is better that students are sure that they know what they are being asked to do and perform to the best of their ability. Teachers can give their students the language that will help them to do this, as well as the practice, in order to give them confidence.
- The interlocutor will only repeat, not rephrase instructions. The interlocutor will also look down to avoid eye contact during the task so as to encourage the candidates to talk to each other. As much as possible, try to do this in class when practising Part 3. It may help some candidates physically to turn towards their partner, so that they can turn-take, move the conversation forward, initiate and listen and respond to their partner.

Suggested follow-up activities

1. Find short descriptions of different holiday destinations (e.g. a luxury hotel by the beach) and ask pairs of students to discuss which place would be good for a family with teenage children to go to for a week. Ask them to decide which two would not be appropriate.
2. List activities which can be done in your area at the weekend. Ask pairs of students to discuss which activities would be suitable for a class outing. Ask them to decide which two would be the most interesting.

Answer key

Student's worksheet

1 c

2 f

3 a

4 g

5 e

6 b

7 d

8 h

Student's worksheet

Look at the sentences about Part 3 of the B2 First for Schools Speaking test. Some of these are true, and some are false. Match each sentence 1–8 with the answer, a–h, below.

1. You will lose marks if you ask for instructions to be repeated.
 2. You should talk to each other and not to the interlocutor.
 3. You should keep talking until the interlocutor stops you.
 4. You must agree with your partner.
 5. It's very important for you to listen to your partner in this section as well as speak.
 6. You should talk about all of the written prompts.
 7. It's important that you and your partner complete the task you are set.
 8. It's okay if the interlocutor interrupts you.
-
- a. **True** – You should try and use up all the time available as in Part 2. To do this you must carry out the task as directed by the interlocutor; the interlocutor will interrupt the discussion in order to ask you to come to a decision. You should try to continue talking about your decision until the interlocutor interrupts you again, which will probably mean they have filled the allotted time. Teachers should give their students as much practice as possible discussing in pairs and small groups, both timed and free.
 - b. **True** – Candidates are asked to 'talk about ...' and in order to fill the time it will probably be necessary for candidates to discuss all the written prompts. The interlocutor will then interrupt in order to ask the candidates to reach a decision, for example, to choose the best option for the scenario. Those who perform less well are those who run out of things to say. Candidates should listen carefully to the interlocutor setting the task and internalise what has been set. However, you will **not** lose marks if you don't talk about all the options.
 - c. **False** – Many candidates start talking in this part of the test without having fully understood the task. If they do, they will not use the right language and they will lose marks. No marks are deducted for asking for instructions to be repeated, and it is better that you are sure that you know what you are being asked to do and perform to the best of your ability.
 - d. **False** – The aim of this part of the test is for you to have an opportunity to show your ability to discuss things and negotiate. There is no right or wrong answer and whether you complete the task or not is not important; it's more important that you have interacted well, and worked towards a solution.
 - e. **True** – You should take a full and interactive part here, making use of the range of text prompts available, expressing your own views clearly, listening to your partner and, where appropriate, developing your partner's comments. You also need to invite your partner to respond and make sure that you both take an equal part in the discussion.

- f. **True** – This is a discussion between you and your partner and you should not try to involve the interlocutor at all. Obviously you can ask the interlocutor to repeat the instructions if you did not understand them clearly.
- g. **False** – You don't have to agree, but you should give a reason if you disagree.
- h. **True** – As with other parts of the Speaking test, candidates should not worry if the interlocutor interrupts them. The interlocutor will need to interrupt in order to ask candidates to reach a decision. Another reason the interlocutor might interrupt is to ensure that the test is completed within the time frame.

Sample task

Part 3

Interlocutor Now, I'd like you to talk about something together for about two minutes (*3 minutes for groups of three*).

I'd like you to imagine that a school is going to start some after-school classes to encourage their students to learn new skills. Here are some ideas for the classes and a question for you to discuss. First you have some time to look at the task.

*Place **Part 3** booklet, open at **Task 21**, in front of the candidates. Allow 15 seconds.*

Now, talk to each other about **why students might want to learn to do these skills**.

Candidates

 *2 minutes
(3 minutes for
groups of three)*

.....

Interlocutor Thank you. Now you have about a minute to decide **which two would be the easiest to learn to do well?**

Candidates

 *1 minute
(for pairs and
groups of three)*

.....

Interlocutor Thank you. (Can I have the booklet, please?) *Retrieve **Part 3** booklet.*

